

The what-not-to-build test

Should AI do this task? Seven yes/no questions to ask before anyone quotes you an AI build. One task, three minutes.

4 verdicts.
2 say not yet.

By Andrew, founder of BlueBridge AI. We use it on our own quotes. Q6 has stopped two.

BlueBridge AI

1 NAME ONE TASK YOUR FIRM DOES BY HAND	e.g. chasing clients for missing documents		
2 TICK YES OR NO, SEVEN TIMES	Yes	No	If no
Q1 Does it happen every week? Twice a year? Keep your money.	☐	☐	STOP
Q2 Have you timed it, from a calendar or a log? A guess isn't a number.	☐	☐	FIX
Q3 Can the person who does it describe it in one sentence? If nobody can say it, nobody can build it.	☐	☐	FIX
Q4 Would two of your people make the same call on the same file? Different answers mean judgment, so a person decides.	☐	☐	ASSIST
Q5 If it gets one wrong, would someone catch it before a client? No checkpoint? Then a person is the checkpoint, on every one.	☐	☐	ASSIST
Q6 Do your rules and contracts allow its data in an outside AI tool? Tax returns, SSNs, wiring details, licensed databases. Not sure counts as no. ↘ 2 real cases	☐	☐	STOP
Q7 Would your client be fine not talking to a person for this part? If the conversation is the service, don't put a machine in it.	☐	☐	STOP

3 FIND YOUR VERDICT Read left to right. The first card that fits is your verdict.

Stop: don't build yet	Fix, then rescore	Assist with sign-off	Automate
Any no on Q1, Q6 or Q7 Next: keep it by hand. Score another task. Example. Accounting: explaining an IRS letter.	Any no on Q2 or Q3 Next: time it, write the sentence, rescore. Example. Title: an order nobody has timed.	Any no on Q4 or Q5 Next: name who approves each AI draft. Example. Insurance: renewal summaries.	All seven yes Next: a one-page spec with your ceiling (\$). Example. Accounting: chasing bank statements.

4 PUT A CEILING ON IT	e.g. 4 hrs a week × \$ 65 an hour × 50 weeks = \$ 13,000 a year The most it can ever save. Weigh every quote and monthly fee against it.
5 SCORE IT TWICE	Differ? Talk before you buy. Your verdict Partner's verdict

Q6, in our own work

Jul 2026. A client wanted a build on its tax software. No API, and the terms forbid it. We said so before quoting.

Aug 2026. A client offered us his logins to a paid research library. His license forbade it. We declined in writing.

When it's yes: we watch the task done first, and price it from your hours and rates.

Both clients unnamed on purpose.

Bring your scored sheet to a free AI discovery call.

We'll tell you honestly whether AI is right for your firm. Sometimes the answer is no. **You leave with a build or don't-build answer on the task you scored.**

calendly.com/bluebridge-gateway

Not ready? Email your verdict to bluebridge.gateway@gmail.com. Andrew replies with his own verdict within one business day.

